Babur’s Campaign Against Tambal

After Baysonqor Mīrzā’s death, Sulṭān Ahmad Qarawal, Quch Beg’s father sent his message of intention to Babur. The message had come together with his brethren, families and dependents from Hisar through Qara Tigin country.

Now, Qambar Ali too had risen from sickness, and he had reached Andijān from Osh. Arriving, as it did, in such a moment, Babur took the preordained help of Sulṭān Ahmad and his party for a happy omen. The very next day, Babur’s men formed at dawn and moved directly upon their foe, Tambal. Sulṭān Ahmad made no stand at Ab-i-Khān and marched from his round, leaving many tents, blankets and things from the baggage of Babur’s men. Babur’s men dismounted at his camp.

On that very evening, Tambal with Jahangir Mīrzā turned to the left of Babur’s men and rode to the Kuban village, fifteen miles away from them.

The next day Babur commanded his men to move out against the enemy. They created the formation left, right, centre, and van, horses, foot soldiers, bearing mantelets, flung to the front. To the right of Babur’s party was Ali Dost and his dependents, on the left was Ibrahim Saru, Wais Laghari, Sayyidi Qara, Muhammad Ali Mubashir and Khwaja-i-Kalan’s elder brother, Kichik Beg, with several of the household. On the left, he also had Sulṭān Ahmad Qarawal and Qiich Beg with their brethren. Babur lay in the centre with Qasim Beg Quchin. In the van were Qambar Ali and some of the households. By the time they reached Saqa, a village two miles east of Khuban, the group of Tambal ventured out, arrayed to fight.

The armies roared and thumped into the fight. The mantelets lay at the rear, and it would have needed abundant labour from the foot soldiers to get them going. But eventually, they never needed it in this aghast situation of war. The enemy was made to bend. Babur ordered the beheading of many but on the advice of his begs, Qasim Beg and especially Ali Dost, they did not push anymore. Hence, not all men of the enemy fell into the hands of Babur, and they were allowed to escape.

Babur and his men dismounted finally in Khuban village.

This battle happened to be Babur’s first fully-ranged one. He has thanked Allah for this triumph and accepted the victory as an omen from the